

SHUCK FALL / UNDERSTANDING CALCIUM

Calcium in the leaf isn't calcium in the cherry.

At shuck fall, cell division is helping establish fruit size potential. Calcium has a structural role in new cell walls.



Illustration of different stages of early cherry development.

An adequate leaf result does not establish adequate calcium in the fruit.

The route into the fruit helps explain why.

FOLLOW THE TWO TRANSPORT PATHWAYS →

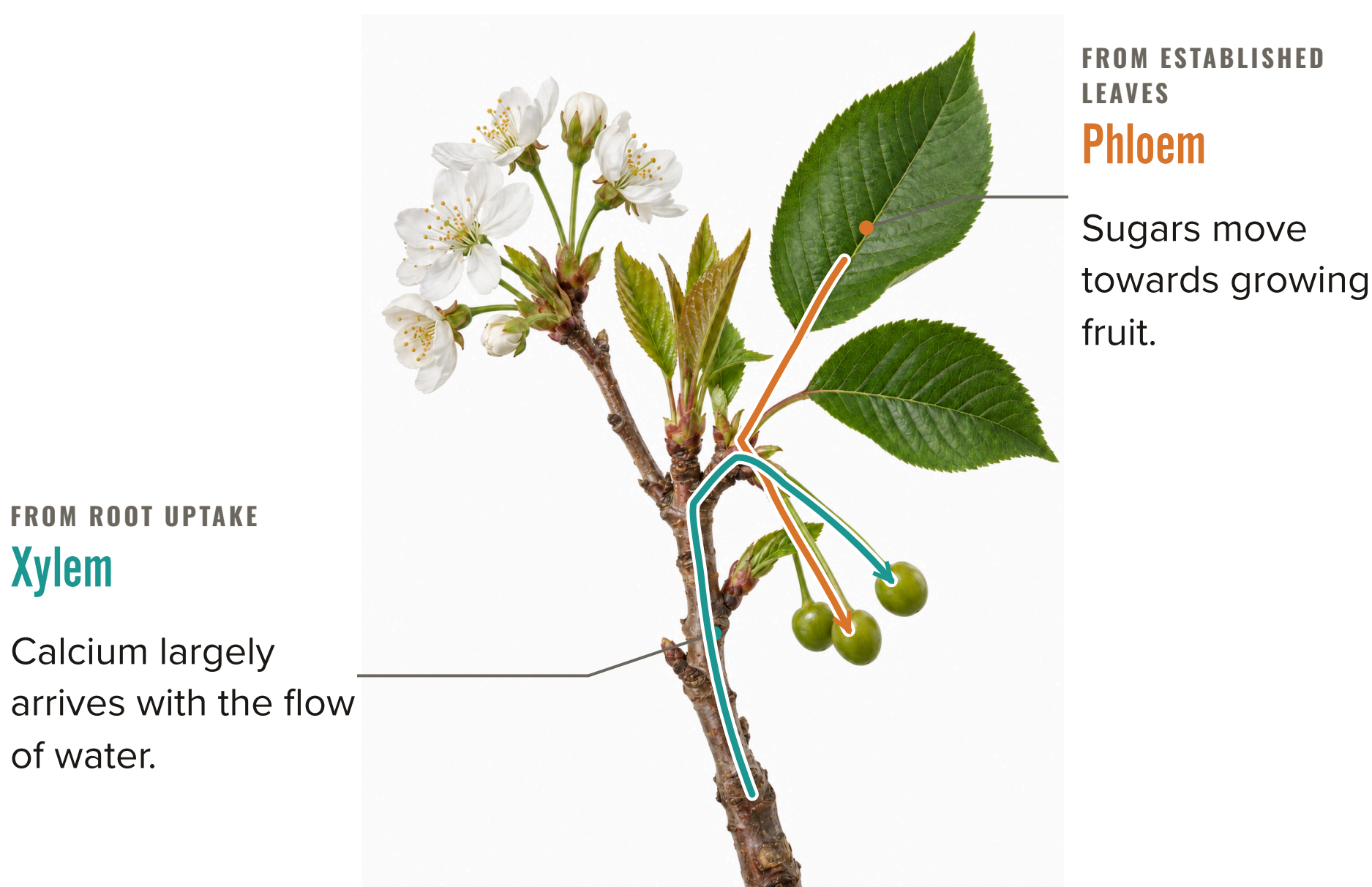
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Calcium and sugar travel differently.

The route through the branch and fruit stalk matters.

TWO DIFFERENT PATHWAYS

Both help support fruit development. They carry different materials.



Calcium is poorly redistributed from older tissues. Its presence in a leaf does not prove delivery to the fruit.

Schematic pathways over a botanical illustration. Flow is not quantified.

Use the result to guide the next investigation.

Differential Sap Analysis adds evidence to the block's nutrition decision.

From paired leaves to a block decision

DSA
PROGRAM CHECKPOINT

Read the youngest fully developed and oldest still-vital leaf samples together, using a consistent sampling protocol.

EVIDENCE

WHAT IT HELPS US EXAMINE

Paired leaf results

Nutrient status in the sampled leaves, including differences between leaf ages.

Earlier tests and recent inputs

How the nutrient picture has changed through the program.

Roots, moisture and crop stage

Possible constraints on uptake and delivery to developing tissues.

Keep the calcium question in context.

A difference between young and old leaves is not automatically a deficiency, and the leaf result is not a fruit measurement.

Assess supply, uptake and delivery before choosing the next input.

Adding more calcium does not automatically get more into the fruit.

Plan the sample and results discussion together with your Hybrid Ag agronomist.